

# What this file does — and what it does not.

Thank you for buying. This guide takes about ten minutes to read and saves you the two mistakes that make rental spreadsheets disagree with reality. Everything here is also printed inside the workbook, on the **Setup** tab.

## In one sentence

Type each booking once and this workbook shows you — for up to **12 properties side by side**, in the month a stay checks out — what is actually left after platform fees, cleaning, laundry, consumables and the costs you logged, plus your occupancy and a turnover list your cleaner can work from.

## What you downloaded

**Short-Term-Rental-Profit-Tracker.xlsx** — five connected tabs: **Setup** (12 properties + your cleaning team) · **Dashboard** (one month, every property side by side) · **Bookings** (300 rows) · **Cleaning** (300 turnovers) · **Costs** (250 rows). A sixth tab, **Lists**, is hidden and feeds the dropdowns.

**This PDF** — the guide you are reading.

## Manual entry — no sync

This file does **not** log in to Airbnb, Booking.com or Vrbo. It does **not** import calendars or .ics files and does **not** read your payouts. You type eight cells per booking.

The realistic routine: once a month, open your platform's payout or reservation list and type the stays down the sheet. For a three-property portfolio that is roughly **ten minutes**.

## The three rules this file counts by

- 1 · The check-out month decides.** Money — booking value, fees, cleaning, consumables — is counted in the month a stay **checks out**. Nights and occupancy are split across months by the actual dates, so a stay over a month border shows nights in both months and money in one. This single rule is why the file never double-counts a stay.
- 2 · Gross booking value = the total the guest paid**, including any cleaning fee you charged them. What you pay *your* cleaner is a cost and belongs in Setup, column E — never in the Bookings tab. Enter the amount before the platform takes its cut; the fee column subtracts it for you.
- 3 · Fixed monthly costs live in Setup only.** They run in every month you look at and appear as their own Dashboard column. Never log them again in the Costs tab — that tab is for one-off and variable costs.

## Two statuses worth understanding

**Cancelled** — the row stays on record, but every calculated column shows — and it reaches no total anywhere.

**Owner block** — your own stay. No income, but the cleaner still comes: cleaning and laundry stay as costs, and those nights leave the available-nights count so your occupancy is not punished for a week you took off.

# Your first fifteen minutes.

The file arrives as a worked example — three properties, twelve bookings, five costs — so you can watch it calculate before you trust it. Here is how to turn it into yours.

## 1 Open it and look around 2 min

Double-click the .xlsx. If Excel shows a yellow **Protected View** bar, click **Enable Editing** — that appears for every downloaded file. Go to the **Dashboard** and change the month picker back and forth: the tiles, every property row and the totals all follow. Nothing here needs typing.

## 2 Setup: overwrite the three example properties 4 min

Rows 25–27 hold the examples. Type over them with your own — name, city, bedrooms, your platform's default fee %, what you pay per turnover for cleaning and laundry, consumables per stay and per night, linen sets, and any cost that runs every month (row 28 onwards is free for properties four to twelve).

**Percentages:** type 3% or 0.03, not 3. **Consumables:** a rough number is fine — coffee, soap, paper. **Fixed monthly costs:** only what genuinely runs every month.

Watch column L. It flags a duplicate property name, and a name containing \* ? or ~ — spreadsheets read those as wildcards and they would quietly mismatch your bookings.

## 3 Add your cleaning team 1 min

Second table on the Setup tab, from row 40 — up to eight names. They become the dropdown in the Cleaning tab. "Me (owner)" is a perfectly good entry.

## 4 Clear the examples 1 min

In **Bookings** clear B5:G16, I5:K16 and S5:S16. In **Cleaning** clear J5:L16. In **Costs** clear B5:H9.

**Leave the numbered # column and every grey cell alone** — they are what keeps Bookings and Cleaning linked. Deleted one by accident? Undo with Ctrl+Z / Cmd+Z, or copy the same cell from the row below and paste it back.

## 5 Type last month's stays 5 min

Open your platform's payout or reservation list and work down it. Per booking you fill: property, platform, status, guest or reference, check-in, check-out, guests, gross booking value. Optionally a fee % override when one stay came in at a different rate. That is all — twelve more columns compute themselves, and the Cleaning tab fills in at the same time.

## 6 Read the Dashboard 1 min

Pick a year and a month in the two white cells. Six tiles and one row per property, side by side: nights, occupancy, gross, every cost line separately, total costs, net and net per available night — the number that lets a studio and a cottage be compared honestly. Then keep it up once a month.

# Excel, Google Sheets, or offline.

No macros, no add-ons, no plug-ins, nothing to install and no account to create. Once the file is on your machine it needs no internet at all.

### Google Sheets

- 1. Open `sheets.google.com` and create a blank spreadsheet.
- 2. Menu **File** ▶ **Import** ▶ **Upload**, choose the .xlsx.
- 3. Pick **Replace spreadsheet** and confirm.
- 4. Rename it and you are done. Formulas, dropdowns and colour rules carry over.

The Dashboard's write-protection is an Excel feature and does not travel. In Google Sheets simply avoid typing on that tab.

### Microsoft Excel

Native format — just open it. The **Dashboard** is write-protected without a password so you cannot type over a formula by accident. Want to restyle it? **Review** ▶ **Unprotect Sheet**, no password needed.

**LibreOffice Calc** opens the file out of the box — for the smoothest experience we recommend Excel or Google Sheets.

### Grey means "this cell calculates itself"

Anywhere in the workbook, a grey cell is a formula. Never clear one and never type into one. Here is where they sit:

| Tab       | You type                                                                                                                         | Grey — calculates itself                                                                                          |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Setup     | Everything except the Check column                                                                                               | Check (duplicate & wildcard warning)                                                                              |
| Dashboard | <b>Only</b> the year and month pickers                                                                                           | Every other cell on the tab                                                                                       |
| Bookings  | Property, platform, status, guest, check-in, check-out, guests, gross booking value — plus the optional fee % override and notes | #, nights, platform fee, payout, cleaning, laundry, consumables, net, net per night, the two month columns, check |
| Cleaning  | Cleaner, cleaning status, notes / access info                                                                                    | #, property, guest, turnover date, days until, same-day flag, guests, linen sets, cleaning cost                   |
| Costs     | Date, property, category, description, amount, paid by, receipt note                                                             | #, check                                                                                                          |

### Currency

Number formats are deliberately currency-neutral — `#,##0.00` with no symbol — so the file works anywhere. Want your symbol? Select the number columns and apply your own currency format in one click.

### Sorting and filtering

Use the filter arrows in row 4 freely. To *sort*, always select the whole table first (Bookings `A4:W304` , Cleaning `A4:L304` , "data has header row") — never a single column on its own. The numbered # column keeps Bookings and Cleaning linked either way.

# The small print, in plain words.

## Growing past 300 bookings

Select the last row of **Bookings** and drag it down as far as you need, then do exactly the same in **Cleaning** so both tabs stay the same length. Finally widen the ranges in the Dashboard formulas, which read rows 5–304 today.

Capacity as delivered: **12 properties · 300 bookings · 300 turnovers · 250 cost rows**. A row pasted below row 304 (Bookings, Cleaning) or 254 (Costs) is not counted anywhere until you extend the ranges.

## Handing the list to a cleaner

Sharing the file shares every tab, including your revenue. To give a cleaner their own list: right-click the **Cleaning** tab ▶ **Copy to ▶ New spreadsheet**, then **Paste special ▶ Values only**, and delete column I — it shows what you pay per turnover.

Guest names are personal data. Share that list only with people who need it.

## What this file does not do

- It does not connect to Airbnb, Booking.com, Vrbo or any other platform, and it never will without you typing.
- It does not import calendars, .ics files, CSV exports or bank statements.
- It calculates **no tax of any kind**. It is not tax, legal, accounting or bookkeeping advice, and it is not a substitute for your accountant.
- It does not price your listing, forecast demand or tell you what your neighbours charge.
- "Net after tracked costs" is gross minus exactly what you typed into this workbook — nothing more. Mortgage, depreciation, income tax and anything you did not enter are not in it.

## Three habits that make it work

- ① One session a month with your payout statement open — type the stays that checked out, in one go.
- ② Log a cost the day it happens; the receipt note field is there so you can find it again.
- ③ Before you judge a month, glance at the data-check line under the Dashboard table. If it says every row is linked, your numbers are complete.

## License

**Personal use.** One buyer, unlimited own properties and devices. You may adapt the file for yourself. Please do not resell, redistribute, share it publicly or include it in another product. Thank you for respecting that — it is what makes small tools like this possible.

## Support

Questions, or a formula that looks wrong? **Message us on Etsy — we reply within 48 h**. If something in the workbook is genuinely broken we fix it and re-upload, and every buyer gets the corrected file.

Telling us what confused you is the most useful thing you can do; the next version of this guide is written from those messages.